Fiscal Year:	FY 2021	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 02/12/2021
PI Name:	Hyers, Robert Ph.D.		
Project Title:	Unified Support for THERMOLAB - ISS, ICOPROSOL, and PARSEC (80NSSC21K0103 ; NNX16AB40G)		
Division Name:	Physical Sciences		
Program/Discipline:			
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	MATERIALS SCIENCE--Materials science		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	None		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	None		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	None		
PI Email:	rwhyers@wpi.edu	**Fax:**	FY
PI Organization Type:	UNIVERSITY	**Phone:**	508-831-5759
Organization Name:	Worcester Polytechnic Institute		
PI Address 1:	100 Institute Road		
PI Address 2:			
PI Web Page:			
City:	Worcester	**State:**	MA
Zip Code:	01609-2280	**Congressional District:**	2
Comments:	Formerly with University of Massachusetts at Amherst.		
Project Type:	Flight	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	2009 ESA AO Biology on Sounding Rockets and Physical Sciences on All Platforms
Start Date:	11/16/2015	**End Date:**	11/30/2025
No. of Post Docs:		**No. of PhD Degrees:**	0
No. of PhD Candidates:	2	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	
No. of Master's Candidates:		**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	1
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	2	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA MSFC
Contact Monitor:	Craven, Paul	**Contact Phone:**	256-544-7649
Contact Email:	pcravenRRR@nasa.gov		
Flight Program:	ISS		
Flight Assignment:	NOTE: Project extended to 11/30/2025 with new grant number 80NSSC21K0103, per NSSC information and P. Craven/MSFC (Ed., 2/12/21)		
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:			
COI Name (Institution):			
Grant/Contract No.:	80NSSC21K0103 ; NNX16AB40G		
Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			

Task Description:	NOTE: Continuation of "Unified Support for THERMOLAB - ISS, ICOPROSOL, and PARSEC," grant NNX10AR71G with the same investigator, Dr. Robert Hyers. NOTE 2/12/2021: Project extended to 11/30/2025 with new grant number 80NSSC21K0103; 80NSSC21K0103 added to project title--Dr. Robert Hyers remains as principal investigator. Robert Hyers is U.S. Team Member on European Space Agencey (ESA)-sponsored projects, "Peritectic Alloy Rapid Solidification with Electromagnetic Convection (PARSEC)," "Thermophysical Properties of Liquid Metallic Alloys - Modelling of Industrial Solidification Processes and Development of Advanced Products (THERMOLAB - ISS)," and "Thermophysical properties and solidification behaviour of undercooled Ti-Zr-Ni liquids showing an icosahedral short-range order (ICOPROSOL)." Funding is for Dr. Hyers's role as Team Member on the subprojects described below, associated with European Space Agency (ESA)-sponsored main projects as noted. Main project: Peritectic Alloy Rapid Solidification with Electromagnetic Convection (PARSEC); Science Coordinator is Dr. Thomas Volkmann, German Aerospace Center DLR, Institut für Materialphysik im Weltraum, Linder Höhe, Köln, Germany Subprojects: 1. Transformation Kinetics-ISS (International Space Station). Task description: Using results from thermophysical property evaluation and combining these with the Magnetohydrodynamic (MHD) convection definition, we will set convection over as wide a range as is possible and conduct recalescence studies from the undercooled melt using the Material Science Laboratory Electromagnetic Levitator (MSL-EML) to compare to results from ground-based EML and ESL. The critical parameters of interest are evaluation of the incubation time between formation of metastable phases and subsequent transformation to the stable phase for Fe-based and titanium aluminide alloys. Since this transformation is very rapid, the high-speed video system must be used to image the processes associated with nucleation and growth during phase selection. 2. Thermophysical Properties. Task description: The density, viscosity, and surface tension of the flight samples will be measured in flight for a range of temperatures. Density will be determined by the video metrology, and surface tension and viscosity by the oscillating drop method. This WP includes determination of parameter modifications required for these measurements as well as collection, reduction, and analysis of the resulting data. The resulting data will support the whole range of theoretical and modeling efforts in this proposal. 3. Modeling of Macroconvection. Task description: Magnetohydrodynamic (MHD) model of macroconvection in the samples for different combinations of experimental parameters. Evaluation of fluid velocity, shear rates, turbulence intensity, and their distribution for control of experiments and input to other theoretical and modeling efforts. Collaboration on development of parameters for other work packages to enable the use of convective state as an experimental parameter. Main project: Thermophysical properties and solidification behaviour of undercooled Ti-Zr-Ni liquids showing an icosahedral short-range order (ICOPROSOL); Science Coordinator is Dr. Dirk Holland-Moritz, Deutsches Zentrum für Luft- und Raumfahrt (DLR), Institut für Materialphysik im Weltraum, Linder Höhe, Köln, Germany. Subproject: Modeling of macroconvection: Magnetohydrodynamic modelling of macroconvection in Ti-Zr-Ni samples for different combinations of experimental parameters. Evaluation of fluid velocity, shear rates, turbulence intensity, and their distribution for control of experiments and input to other theoretical and modeling efforts. Main project: Thermophysical Properties of Liquid Metallic Alloys - Modelling of Industrial Solidification Processes and Development of Advanced Products (THERMOLAB - ISS); Science Coordinator is Professor Hans-Joerg Fecht, Ulm University, Ulm, Germany Subprojects: Long Duration Microgravity Experiments - ISS. Evaluation of microgravity experiments for fluid flow investigations. MODELLING A: Thermodynamics, Phase Selection. Modelling of nucleation under various flow conditions for steel alloys. MODELLING B: Non-contact thermophysical. Modeling of magnetohydrodynamic convection and shear in 1-g, microgravity for 4-6 alloys. Modeling of Marangoni convection in 1-g ESL drops for comparison with microgravity experiments. Modeling of temperature distribution in 1-g and microgravity samples, 4-6 alloys. Input into design of experimental parameters for 4-6 Alloys.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	This project consists of modeling in support of three different flight experiments: - PARSEC - Peritectic Alloy Rapid Solidification with EM Convection - ThermoLAB - Thermophysical Properties of Liquid Metallic Alloys - ICOPROSOL - Thermophysical properties and solidification behaviour of undercooled Ti-Zr-Ni liquids showing an icosahedral short-range order In PARSEC, we are investigating the effect of fluid flow on the solidification path of certain alloys. Control of the solidification path would enable tailoring of the microstructure and properties of metal parts for specific applications. In ThermoLAB, we are investigating the thermophysical properties of high-temperature materials. Many of these materials are used commercially. A better understanding of the physical properties will allow more efficient and more reliable production of metallic parts using these alloys. Other alloys are chosen because of scientific interest in their properties, which may illuminate fundamental physics related to the formation of bulk metallic glasses and quasicrystals.

	In ICOPROSOL, we are investigating the nucleation and growth of quasicrystals, and the effect of atomic-scale order on the macroscopic properties of these alloys. This fundamental investigation may improve our ability to tailor the microstructure of metals for commercial applications.
Task Progress:	Highlights of Work Accomplished During Grant Period 2016-2020. • Completed the magnetohydrodynamic calculations for analysis of the transition to turbulence in positioner-dominated flow in MSL-EML for SEMITHERM ("Investigations of Thermophysical Properties of Liquid Semiconductors in the Melt and in the Undercooled State under Microgravity Conditions"). • Prepared journal article on these results. • Completed the magnetohydrodynamic calculations for analysis of the effect of flow on unusual growth of the solid in Al-Ni for NEQUISOL (Non-Equilibrium Solidification, Dendrite Growth Velocities & Modelling for Microstructure Engineering of Industrial Alloys). • Presented results at The Minerals, Metals & Materials Society (TMS) Annual Meeting 2019. • Presented at Investigators' Working Group Meeting on MSL-EML at Airbus, Friedrichshafen, May 2019. • Image processing code for the analysis of MSL-EML data is being adjusted (expect to process the data downloaded from ISS this fall.) • Ms. Gwendolyn Bracker defended her M.S. in August 2019. She is continuing as a PhD student. • Ms. Bracker presented her research at the International Workshop on Subsecond Thermophysics at DLR Cologne in June 2019. • PI presented further results at the International Workshop on Subsecond Thermophysics at DLR Cologne in June 2019. • Ms. Jie Zhao defended her PhD thesis in December 2018. • Presented at ESA ISS-EML Batch 4 AO workshop EML at Airbus, Friedrichshafen, May 2019. • Submitted 2 proposals for Batch 4 as PI, and 9 more as co-I. Both Batch 4 proposals were selected; they were the basis of the renewal award. (Ed. note February 2021: renewal extends NNX16AB40G as grant 80NSSC21K0103 to 11/30/2025 and is incorporated in this Task Book record.)
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 03/30/2026)
Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Bracker G, Baker EB, Nawer J, Sellers ME, Gangopadhyay AK, Kelton KF, Xiao X, Lee J, Reinartz M, Burggraf S, Herlach D, Rettenmayr M, Matson DM, Hyers RW. "The effect of flow regime on surface oscillations during electromagnetic levitation experiments." High Temperatures-High Pressures. 2020;49(1-2):49-60. https://doi.org/10.32908/hthp.v49.817 , Mar-2020
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Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Matson DM, Hyers RW, Sansoucie M, McFadden S, Lee J, Sillekens W, Ishikawa T. "Materials Research in Reduced Gravity 2020. Introduction to and description of papers in special issue from a special session at 149th TMS meeting." JOM. 2020 Sep;72(9):3121–2. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11837-020-04290-6 , Sep-2020
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Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Wunderlich RK, Mohr M, Dong Y, Hecht U, Matson DM, Hyers, R, Bracker G, Lee J, Schneider S, Xiao X and Fecht H-J. "Thermophysical properties of the TiAl-2Cr-2Nb alloy in the liquid phase measured with an electromagnetic levitation device on board the International Space Station, ISS-EML." International Journal of Materials Research. 2021 Oct 15;112:770-81. https://doi.org/10.1515/ijmr-2021-8266 , Oct-2021
Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Bracker GP, Luo Y, Damaschke B, Samwer K, Hyers RW. "Examining the influence of turbulence on viscosity measurements of molten germanium under reduced gravity." npjMicrogravity. 2022 Nov 24;(8)53. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41526-022-00238-z , Nov-2022